

Title: *False wonders*

Keywords: Women, Lesbian, Relationship, Contradictory, Daily,

Attending type: In-person

Biographical:

Haoyi Song is currently a full-time Ph.D. student at the University of Texas at Dallas in Visual and Performing Arts. Song graduated in 2021 from the University of Leeds in the United Kingdom with a master's degree in Culture, Creativity, and Entrepreneurship. Song holds a bachelor's degree in oil painting from Sichuan Fine Arts Institute. She has six years of art teaching experience in China. As an independent artist, Song had been invited as a resident artist in Chongqing, China for three years. She immersed herself in creating artwork with local community support and practiced her artistic techniques using various materials (i.e., oil painting, installations, cryotherapy). Her specific interest is in oil painting with topics related to memory, dream, relationship, and everyday life.

Concept Note:

As a female artist, I am interested in common things in daily life. The creation of this painting was based on my personal experience as an immigrant lesbian living in the United States. When I was living in my motherland, I could share most of my daily life with my families and friends, because their understanding of reality was very similar to my own interpretation. I, however, was not feeling comfortable to express my feelings as a lesbian artist in China because of the sociocultural oppression on the lesbian population. After I came to the United States, things have been changed. I felt respects from my American friends and co-workers after I came out to them, but I have encountered challenges and difficulties to resonant my feelings toward theirs because of different cultural backgrounds. Particularly, I barely know how to respond to people in social situations or what social manners and behavioral norms are appropriate in the United States. The boundary between others and me is messy and distorted because of non-adaptive experience. Therefore, I used the bed as a symbol to express these mismatched feeling.

This painting depicts three forty-five-degree interlocking beds. The bed, as a very important and an intimate piece of furniture in daily life, represents ordinary, everyday life. The medium used for this painting is oil on wood board. The size is 4 by 4 feet. The dominant colors are pure red, yellow, and blue. A low-saturated blue-violet color connects these three colors of higher purity.

This painting aims to deliver the beautiful dreams of peaceful life with the real pain and mismatched feelings in the reality. The hope is expressed by harmonious colors and gentle textures in oil painting. The uncomfortable feelings are sensed through the thorns growing out of these two beds. The oxymoron in a female, lesbian, immigrant's daily life is informed via this painting. More sociocultural supports are needed for women, especially marginalized populations to fulfill their colorful dreams.

Creative work:

